



Laser vs Sun?

Scientists have created a LASER as powerful as all the sunlight hitting the earth. <http://dgit.in/may21-54>



Samsung's Trebles

Samsung phones could get Android 12 quicker thanks to Treble. <http://dgit.in/may21-55>

Acer Aspire 7 NH.QAYSI.001

Punching above its weight class

The Acer Aspire 7 gaming laptop costs less than ₹60,00 and is powered by AMD's Ryzen 5000-series CPU along with an NVIDIA GTX 1650 GPU. It's surprising to see such a value offering in this price range.

DESIGN AND BUILD QUALITY

Despite being a gaming laptop, the Aspire 7 isn't built to look like one. It looks plain and very generic, which makes it easier to fit in most environments without looking overly obnoxious.

The chassis is made entirely of plastic, which is unsurprising at this price point. However, it doesn't feel overly cheap. At 2.15 kgs, it's not exactly lightweight but it's travel-friendly and super portable.

Overall, the Acer Aspire 7 gaming laptop is an unremarkable machine when it comes to looks but that doesn't necessarily make it a bad choice. It's got a serviceable build quality and it should be just fine as long as you don't handle it roughly.

DISPLAY

The Acer Aspire 7 gaming laptop sports a 15.6-inch display that has a native resolution of 1920x1080 pixels. It's got a matte finish that keeps hash reflections at bay and makes it easier on the eyes. It provides a decent contrast ratio of 1361:1 and has a peak brightness of 268.3 cd/m². The brightness of the display is a little on the lower side.

Another important thing is that the display only supports up to 60 Hz refresh rate which is not very desirable on a gaming laptop.

The average DeltaE colour deviation was 6.21 with max DeltaE values touching as high as 20.59. So not only does the laptop miss the target of DeltaE values under 4, some colours like Blue are extremely off.



Price
₹56,990

KEYBOARD, TRACKPAD, AND I/O

The Acer Aspire 7 gaming laptop is equipped with a backlit chiclet keyboard with an integrated number pad. It's a very comfortable keyboard and the touchpad, too, is very simple. It's got a smooth surface which makes it easier for your fingers to glide on.

Coming to ports, on the left side, you'll see two USB 3.0 Type-A ports, a USB Type-C port without PD, an HDMI output, and an Ethernet jack.

On the right side, you get another USB Type-A port along with a combo headphone/microphone jack and a power connector.

PERFORMANCE

With 3DMark's Time Spy test, we pushed the limits of the GTX 1650 GPU and it managed to give us a score of 3638, beating the more expensive Lenovo Legion 5i with a 10th gen Intel Core i5-10300H and the same GTX 1650.

In PCMark 10's extended test, the Aspire 7 gaming laptop's score of 5168 was better than the Lenovo Legion 5i (10th gen Intel Core i7-10750H) which only scored 4091.

In gaming, Acer Aspire 7 hits the 60 FPS mark even at max settings in a lot of games such as GTA 5, Doom Eternal, Forza Horizon 4 and Apex Legends. The Nvidia GTX 1650 was maxing out its usage. The CPU usage, however, stayed around 70 per cent which means it had enough headroom left.

THERMALS

We did most of our testing in 24-28 degrees ambient temperature, and the laptop managed to stay relatively cool throughout the process. The fans also kick in as soon as you start running a resource-intensive task like a game, and this can be controlled via the AMD Radeon software.

BATTERY LIFE

The Acer Aspire 7 gaming laptop packs a 3-cell 48 Wh battery which managed to last for 5 hours and 9 minutes in PCMark's Modern office battery test. This is significantly longer than both

the ASUS TUF Gaming A15 that's powered by the Ryzen 7 4800H, and the HP Omen 15 2020 that's powered by the Intel Core i7-10750H.

VERDICT

For the price of ₹57,000, you are essentially getting a very functional laptop that's perfect for day-to-day workloads and it's got the chops to handle FHD gaming. Yes, it's not an ultraslim laptop and it doesn't have eye-catching looks, but it certainly makes up for that with its performance and value.

—Karthik Iyer

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: AMD Ryzen 5 5500U (2.1 GHz base clock, up to 4.0 GHz max boost clock, 8 MB L3 cache, 6 cores) | GRAPHICS: NVIDIA GeForce GTX 1650 | RAM: 8 GB DDR4-3200 | STORAGE: 512 GB PCIe NVMe SSD | DISPLAY: 15.6-inch FHD IPS anti-glare panel.

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